

Lesson 8 — 祝你生日快樂

Happy Birthday to You!

Let's Learn Mandarin · Book 1 · Teacher's Manual

壹、教學目標 — Learning Objectives

1. Students can recognize and express dates.
 2. Students can say their birthday and age.
 3. Students can make requests and express wishes.
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貳、暖身活動 — Warm-Up Activities

1. Review numbers and the vocabulary for months and days introduced in previous lessons. Ask students questions like “今天幾號？” (What's today's date?) and “你幾歲？” (How old are you?) to activate prior knowledge.
 2. In small groups, have students ask each other about their birthdays using sentence frames from earlier lessons. Introduce the theme of birthday celebrations and gifts to build context for the new lesson.
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參、詞語說明 — Vocabulary Notes

1. 祝你..... (zhù nǐ.....) — “I wish you...”

祝 means “to wish (someone something).” It is always followed by the recipient and then the blessing or wish.

- 祝你生日快樂。 — Happy birthday to you. (lit. “I wish you a happy birthday.”)
- 祝你身體健康。 — I wish you good health.

2. 樂 (lè / yuè) — Polyphonic Character

樂 has two common readings: - **lè** — happy, joyful (快樂 = happy) - **yuè** — music (音樂 = music)

Students should take care to distinguish these two readings by context.

3. 大哥 / 大姐 (dàgē / dàjiě) — “Eldest Brother / Eldest Sister”

In Chinese, siblings are distinguished by birth order. The prefix 大 (big/eldest) indicates the firstborn: - 大哥 — eldest brother - 大姐 — eldest sister - 二哥 / 二姐 — second brother / second sister

4. 請 (qǐng) — “Please” / “To Treat”

請 has two related meanings: - As a polite request marker: 請進。 — Please come in. - As a verb meaning “to treat someone (to a meal, etc.):” 我請你吃飯。 — I'll treat you to a meal.

5. 噢 (òu) — Exclamatory Reaction Particle

噢 is used to express a reaction — surprise, realization, or understanding. It is pronounced òu (4th tone) and is different from 喔 (ō, 1st tone), which expresses acknowledgment.

- 噢，今天是你的生日！— Oh, today is your birthday!

6. 年 vs. 歲 (nián vs. suì) — “Year” vs. “Years Old”

Students often confuse these two: - 年 (nián) — refers to a year as a unit of time (e.g., 今年 = this year; 去年 = last year) - 歲 (suì) — refers to a person's age (e.g., 我十七歲。 = I am seventeen years old.)

These two words are not interchangeable. 歲 is used only when talking about how old someone is.

肆、句型說明 — Grammar Patterns

Grammar Pattern 1 — Expressing Dates: 月份、號/日

Dates in Mandarin follow the order: **year** → **month** → **day**, from largest to smallest unit.

Pattern: (幾月) + 幾號 / 幾日

- 幾 is used as “what number” when asking about dates.
- 號 (hào) is the colloquial form used in speech.
- 日 (rì) is the formal/written form.

Chinese	English
今天是幾月幾號？	What is today's date?
今天是八月十一號。	Today is August 11th.
我的生日是三月五號。	My birthday is March 5th.
他是一月一日出生的。	He was born on January 1st.

Teaching Tip: Teach students 號 for everyday use and introduce 日 as the written/formal equivalent. Practice the names of all twelve months as a set.

Grammar Pattern 2 — Asking About Dates and Ages: 幾月幾號 / 幾歲

Pattern 2-1: Asking the Date

Chinese	English
明天是幾月幾號？	What is tomorrow's date?
明天是八月十一號。	Tomorrow is August 11th.
你的生日是幾月幾號？	What date is your birthday?

Pattern 2-2: Asking Age

Chinese	English
你幾歲？	How old are you?
我（是）十七歲。	I am seventeen years old.
明天是我十七歲的生日。	Tomorrow is my seventeenth birthday.

Teaching Note: In colloquial speech, 是 before an age expression can be omitted: 我十七歲 is perfectly natural. Students should be aware of both forms.

Grammar Pattern 3 — Tag Questions for Suggestions and Requests: 好不好? / 可以嗎?

These sentence-final expressions are used to seek agreement or permission. They soften a statement or request into a question.

Pattern 3-1: 好不好? — “Okay? / Is that all right?”

Used when making a suggestion and inviting the listener to agree.

Chinese	English
你請我去吃大餐，好不好？	You treat me to a big meal, okay?
我們去唱歌，好不好？	Let's go sing karaoke, okay?

Pattern 3-2: 可以嗎? — “Can I? / Is it okay?”

Used when making a request and asking for permission.

Chinese	English
我要一雙運動鞋，可以嗎？	I'd like a pair of athletic shoes — is that okay?
我現在去，可以嗎？	May I go now?

Teaching Tip: Contrast 好不好? (inviting agreement on a joint plan) with 可以嗎? (asking for permission). Both are very natural in everyday speech.

伍、課文教學 — Text Instruction

Suggested Teaching Flow

1. **Before reading:** Ask students warm-up questions about birthdays — when theirs is, how they like to celebrate, what kinds of gifts they enjoy.
2. **First listening:** Play the audio or read the dialogue aloud while students listen with books closed.
3. **Comprehension check:** Use the suggested questions below.
4. **Second listening/reading:** Students follow along in their books.
5. **Role-play:** Students practice the dialogue in pairs, focusing on the natural use of 好不好? and 可以嗎?

Suggested Comprehension Questions

1. 明天是幾月幾號? — What is tomorrow's date?
2. 明天是誰的生日? — Whose birthday is it tomorrow?
3. 他/她幾歲了? — How old are they turning?
4. 他/她想要什麼生日禮物? — What birthday gift do they want?
5. 他/她怎麼說? 用了什麼句子? — How did they ask? What sentence pattern did they use?
6. 另一個人怎麼回答? — How did the other person respond?
7. 他們要去哪裡慶祝生日? — Where are they going to celebrate?
8. 你喜歡怎麼慶祝生日? — How do you like to celebrate your birthday?
9. 你的生日是幾月幾號? — When is your birthday?
10. 你幾歲? — How old are you?
11. 你的生日禮物想要什麼? — What would you like as a birthday gift?

Key Sentences from the Text

- 明天是幾月幾號？— What is tomorrow's date?
- 明天是八月十一號。— Tomorrow is August 11th.
- 明天是我十七歲的生日。— Tomorrow is my seventeenth birthday.
- 我要一雙運動鞋，可以嗎？— I'd like a pair of athletic shoes — is that okay?
- 你請我去吃大餐，好不好？— You treat me to a big meal, okay?

Narration Activity

Have students retell the story of the dialogue from memory using a narrative framework. Prompt them to include the date, whose birthday it is, what the person wants, and what the plan is for celebration.

陸、綜合活動 — Integrated Activities

Activity 1

Students interview three classmates about their birthdays. They fill in a chart with each person's name, birthday (month and day), and age, then report the information to the class using complete sentences.

Activity 2

Students write a short paragraph about their own birthday: when it is, how old they will be, and what they would like to do or receive.

Activity 3

Students practice making requests using 可以嗎？ and suggestions using 好不好？. In pairs, one student makes a request or suggestion; the other responds with agreement, disagreement, or a counterproposal.

Activity 4 — Birthday Card Reading

Students read a sample birthday card written in Chinese and answer comprehension questions: - Who is the card addressed to? - What is the date? - What wishes are expressed?

Activity 5 — Birthday Card Writing

Students write a birthday card in Chinese to a classmate, family member, or fictional character. The card should include: - The date - A birthday greeting using 祝你..... - A birthday wish or blessing

柒、補充課文 — Supplementary Texts

Supplementary Text I (Dialogue)

(A dialogue about a birthday falling on April 1st. The person is turning 18 and wants a computer as a birthday gift.)

True/False Exercise — Answers:

#	Answer
1	○ (True)
2	✗ (False)
3	✗ (False)
4	○ (True)

Supplementary Text II (Reading Passage)

(A short reading passage about Mary, who is turning 22 on May 17th. She wants a pair of athletic shoes as a birthday gift.)

Comprehension Questions and Answers:

1. 瑪麗的生日是幾月幾號？— Mary's birthday is May 17th.
2. 她今年幾歲？— She is turning 22 this year.
3. 她的生日禮物想要什麼？— She wants a pair of athletic shoes.

捌、語音教學 — Phonetics

Finals: -ia, -uan, -üan

-ia

The final -ia is a compound final combining [i] + [a]. The [i] glides quickly into [a].

Syllable	Example	Meaning
jiā	家	home / family
xiā	蝦	shrimp
yā	鴨	duck

-uan

The final -uan combines [u] + [a] + [n]. Note the spelling rule: after j, q, x, and y, the [ü] vowel is written as u, so juan, quan, xuan, yuan all use the ü vowel despite being written with u.

Syllable	Example	Meaning
guān	關	to close
huān	歡	joy
yuán	元	yuan (currency) / origin

-üan

The final -üan (written -uan after j, q, x, y) combines [ü] + [a] + [n].

Syllable	Example	Meaning
juǎn	捲	to roll
quān	圈	circle
xuān	宣	to announce

Spelling Rule Reminder: After j, q, x, and y, ü is always written as u. So 月 is written yuè (not yüè). Remind students that this is a spelling convention, not a change in pronunciation.

玖、解答 — Answer Keys

Grammar Exercise Answers

(Answers correspond to the grammar exercises in the student textbook for Lesson 8.)

Dates (月份、號/日): Students practice writing and saying dates in Chinese. Accept 號 or 日 interchangeably unless the exercise specifies one form.

Age (幾歲): Students write sentences describing their age and the ages of family members using 歲.

好不好? / 可以嗎?: Students complete or write sentences using these tag question patterns. Answers will vary based on the context of each item.

Integrated Activity Answers

- **Activity 1:** Answers vary (interview results about classmates' birthdays).
 - **Activity 2:** Answers vary (personal birthday paragraphs).
 - **Activity 3:** Answers vary (paired role-play with requests and suggestions).
 - **Activity 4:** Answers vary based on the birthday card provided.
 - **Activity 5:** Answers vary (student-created birthday cards).
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Phonetics Exercise Answers

(Refer to the student workbook. Students practice writing Pinyin with correct tones for syllables containing -ia, -uan, and -üan. Check for correct application of the ü → u spelling rule after j, q, x, y.)

Workbook Answer Key

I. *(Listening: circle the correct Pinyin — answers depend on audio)*

II. *(Listening: mark the tones — answers depend on audio)*

III. *(Read aloud and write the Pinyin — sample answers)* 1. 家 — jiā 2. 歡 — huān 3. 元 — yuán 4. 捲 — juǎn 5. 圈 — quān

IV. *(Fill in 號 or 日 as appropriate)* 1. 號 (colloquial/spoken context) 2. 日 (formal/written context) 3. 號 4. 日

V. *(Write the date in Chinese)* Answers vary based on the dates given in the exercise.

VI. *(Fill in 年 or 歲)* 1. 歲 — 我十七歲。 2. 年 — 今年是...年。 3. 歲 — 她二十二歲。 4. 年 — 去年他去了...

VII. *(Write a short paragraph about your birthday using 好不好? or 可以嗎?)* Answers vary (personal writing).

Test Answer Key

I. Listen and circle the correct Pinyin. *(Answers depend on audio)*

II. Listen and mark the tones. *(Answers depend on audio)*

III. Read aloud and write the Pinyin. (Sample answers based on lesson vocabulary)

IV. Writing / Production Answers vary (students write sentences about dates, ages, and requests using the target patterns).

拾、線上資源 — Online Resources

Chinese Character Stroke Order: Students can look up the correct stroke order for new characters at: → [stroke order reference website]

Character Instructional Videos: Videos demonstrating stroke order and structure are available for the following characters introduced in Lesson 8:

- 日 (rì) — sun / day
- 月 (yuè) — moon / month
- 明 (míng) — bright / tomorrow

Birthday Song: The Chinese birthday song 祝你生日快樂 is widely available on YouTube. Playing it in class is a fun way to reinforce the lesson's key vocabulary and introduce the cultural context of birthday celebrations in Chinese-speaking communities.

→ [YouTube link — 祝你生日快樂]

拾壹、補充漢字 — Character Writing Practice

噢 (òu)

Meaning: Exclamatory particle expressing surprise, realization, or understanding

Stroke order: [stroke order grid]

Components: 口 (mouth) radical on the left + 奧 phonetic component on the right

噢 噢 噢 噢 噢 噢

Students practice writing 噢 following the correct stroke order. Note the distinction in meaning and tone between 噢 (òu — surprise/realization) and 喔 (ō — acknowledgment).

拾貳、第八課測驗 — Lesson 8 Quiz

Lesson 8 Quiz

I. Listen and circle the correct Pinyin.

1. a. jiā (b) xiā (c) yā
2. a. guān (b) huān (c) yuán
3. a. juǎn (b) quān (c) xuān
4. a. jiā (b) jiǎn (c) jiàn
5. a. yuán (b) wán (c) huán

II. Listen and mark the tones.

1. jia

2. huan
3. yuan
4. juan
5. xuan

III. Read aloud and write the Pinyin.

1. 家 — _____
2. 歡 — _____
3. 元 — _____
4. 捲 — _____
5. 月 — _____

IV. Answer the following questions in complete Chinese sentences.

1. 今天是幾月幾號？
2. 你的生日是幾月幾號？
3. 你今年幾歲？
4. 你的生日禮物想要什麼？請用「可以嗎？」造句。
5. 你想怎麼慶祝你的生日？請用「好不好？」造句。